GMS WEEKLY

Your Source for Recycling News

August 1st, 2025
Week 31
Volume 275, Issue 1196

Highlights:

- **'Two Weeks'.**
- **Russian sanctions?**
- **Volatility.**
- **Market improves?**
- **Bangla lags.**
- **Scan to download / view the Weekly on the GMS App!**

QUOTE of the WEEK

"You can't be that kid standing at the top of the waterslide, overthinking it. You have to go down the chute."

– Tina Fey

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

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ROCKY MOVES!

As the shipping and ship-recycling worlds seemingly collide going down a rabbit hole of this thoughtlessly induced global economic turmoil bought on by a blind surgeon, we can undoubtedly expect to see further issues arising in the coming weeks (unless immediate countermeasures aren't enacted) as president "two weeks" finally approved a wave of tariffs (infamously declared on April 4th as Liberation Day) against U.S. imports from dozens of countries, including Canada, Taiwan, India, and surprisingly, even Russia as in a show of force against Putin's unrelenting and truly unabated aggression in Ukraine, this week Trump reportedly instructed CentCom to strategically re-position two nuclear submarines at undisclosed locations off of Russian shores. This move, in addition to the sanctioning of not only Russian oil, but also those trading Russian oil, is reportedly expected to see over 1,000 vessels enter the dreaded OFAC list, leaving their futures in disarray.

And the inevitably of his actions is already starting to (sort of) bear fruit for the ship recycling sector as a gradual inflow of tankers into India and bulkers into Pakistan over recent weeks (including this one), has seen fresh arrivals at both locations this week. The Baltic Exchange dry index also reported a 0.75% overall jump brought on by the Cape and Supramax indices that firmed 1.8% and 0.1% respectively this week, all while the Panamax index fell nearly 1% of its total value, an over 10% drop in weekly trading. Unsuspiciously, both wet and small-to-medium size dry units are expected to continue sailing into the Indian sub-continent ship recycling markets through August, given that the sanctions have already seen oil futures in turmoil as they declined an unpopular (well any negative number is unpopular) 2.7% this week, closing it out at USD 67.30/barrel.

Fundamentals at ship recycling destinations also displayed results similar to a darts contest at a blind congregation, all over the board this week (just as they have been over the recent past) despite 'some' price stability and even improvements being registered, resulting in a growing collection of fixtures into the sub-continent recycling markets of late – most notably were the two larger LDT LNGs into India and even two bulkers into a resurgent Pakistan, with reports of slow but ongoing improvements to local yards coming forth.

Speaking of, HKC requirements enacted a mere 5 weeks ago have also sent owners, cash buyers, and end buyers into headwinds at the tail end of a vessels life due to the unfolding confusions and ensuing delays during final delivery, though the industry does seem to be collectively (albeit slowly) getting accustomed to the changing documentary requirements and inward procedures prior the vessel's arrival. As a reminder, IHM parts I, II and III are being required for any vessel heading to any Indian sub-continent ship-recycling destination, along with SRPs (Ship Recycling Plans), SRFPs (Ship Recycling Facility Plans) and even confirmations from flag states that the vessels are headed for recycling. Overall, Bangladesh remains positioned just behind both India and Pakistan (with the number of arrivals at the waterfront to match), as Turkey remains marooned in no man's land with nothing more than deteriorating fundamentals to report week after week. Is it 2026 yet?

GMS demo rankings / pricing for week 31 of 2025 are on Page 5.

BANGLADESH

BACKLOGS BITE!

Lowest still.

The Bangladeshi ship recycling market remains the lowest placed of all sub-continent destinations for yet another week / month and as such, has been unable to partake in much (if at all) of the activity at the bidding tables of late. And this level of pervading disinterest to be competitive has seen the waterfront suffer over the last 3 weeks with minimal arrivals and deliveries ensuing, including this one, where just a lonesome albeit decent LDT tanker arrived the nations recycling waterfront this week, and remains idling (likely) awaiting its tide.

Frustrations abound.

Meanwhile, the incessant rains in the face of reported global warming wrapped in the threat of impending tariffs saw fundamentals hammering the purchasing mindset of local buyers as despite the Bangladeshi Taka displaying a degree of stability and even firming 30 basis points against the U.S. Dollar to end the week at BDT 21.52 (thanks to the central bank's reported intervention last week), it was steel plate prices that fell another USD 2/Ton as recycled steel fails to move from yards to domestic steel mills. And with the recently reported trade deal between steel mills and steel importers at levels far lower than current rates, there has been a growing frustration at the lack of constructive movement from the interim government to help move the domestic steel industry forward or even announce any government-backed or subsidized infrastructure projects to help the nation's economy for over 12 months now, which is leading to a reduced overall demand for steel - and ships.

HKC underway.

As such, much of the growing steel inventory at local yards that was previously concluded at much higher prices (than today), is now starting to backlog post recycling and this is creating even more frustrations for recyclers that are now starting to extend beyond merely financial. The ongoing shortage of a monsoon induced worker shortage at Chattogram recycling yards is also not doing anyone locally any favors, which may have its own silver-lining in that, a slowdown in recycling of recently delivered units stands to extend the overall process, likely beyond the monsoons and into late September during which time, there may hopefully be some economic reprieve.

Tariff tricks.

Notwithstanding, HKC developments have reportedly continued at pace at the remainder of yards with works is ongoing, in order to get all local yards up to HKC standards and continue operating as the number of disinterested Bangladeshi recyclers at the bidding tables is clearly starting to affect Chattogram's anchorage. Moreover, with inflation reducing in June and July hopefully following the trend (awaiting official July numbers), the Central Bank may hopefully re-adjust lending rates thereby helping local recyclers on future vessel purchases. Bangladesh's stock exchange has also rallied since last year as it climbed a whopping 6.9% in July and over 46.45% during the same time 12 months ago.

But with tariffs against Bangladesh now reportedly in effect, the nation's growing GDP is expected to take a notable hit across Q3 – and likely beyond. Just how this will affect the nation's ship recycling waterfront remains to be seen. For now, we don't expect any meaningful transactions to take place until August likely comes to pass.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA

ROSIER GLOW?

Recent LNG sales into India have given this market, a rosier glow than they perhaps would otherwise have expected bearing in mind, the incessant volatility in local steel plate prices has seen them go through a bit of a roller coaster ride this week as they started and end the week at the same level. And this volatility in steel that has seen far more declines through Q3, was also joined by ongoing currency woes that saw the Rupee fall a drastic 93 basis points against the U.S. Dollar and end the week at Rs. 87.37, leaving Alang resting in 2nd and even 3rd place on the market rankings for a majority of 2025.

Competitive.

Logically, given that India remains a specialist in non-ferrous trade, has certainly helped this market keep the final destinations of most LNGs routed to Alang's shores where demand for non-ferrous and non-ferrous vessel remains high, thanks to the above average quantities of aluminium and stainless steel onboard these units that has helped them achieve prices far in excess of prevailing averages, thanks to these vessels being particularly high in demand here.

Non-ferrous desires.

Meanwhile, domestic yard capacity and HKC infrastructure upgrades were at the forefront of Alang ship recyclers since 2014, invariably helping key local recyclers snag high-profile vessels from the fleets of blue-chip owners. This fundamental shift in the global mentality from the ship owning fraternity saw a better quality and grade of maintained vessels arriving Alang, much to the envy of non-HKC neighbouring yard owners who then went on to pursue HKC certifications of their own, gradually planting the initial seeds for further progress across Alang's landscape. 12 years later, this process has snowballed to where nearly every ship recycling yard is HKC SoC approved and the only thing needed for the local community and governmental agencies was to modify NOR documents at the time of arrival in a post June 26th / HKC world.

HKC ready.

The result of which, continues to be a busy anchorage for Alang's ship recycling community that has struggled with tonnage availability for well over a year now, and recyclers here have been the busiest in the sub-continent, taking in a breadth of types and volumes of tonnage over recent weeks including this one, where a couple of new tankers arrived locally, in addition to a few final deliveries. Clearly, the number of open and available local buyers over these stagnating monsoon months has survived behind the scenes, who have been monitoring tonnage movements and decidedly picking up units now that prices have bottomed out and global tumult gradually starts to drive tonnage towards retirement. Tariffs imposed this week are certainly on the minds of Indian businesses and these are expected to keep recycling vessel prices in check, at least in the short term / through August.

Tough call.

As such, for owners looking for their own shades of green recycling, India has and will continue to offer the best option while Pakistani buyers may offer suspect conditions, albeit at notably firmer prices. Certainly, a tough call for most owners who are pushed to recycling in recent times.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

PAKISTAN

GLEEFUL!

Saving grace.

The top placed Indian sub-continent ship recycling market, Gadani, continues to defy industry expectations over these miserable monsoon months despite having been altogether absent from the bidding tables about 6 months ago. Clearly, demand and pricing remains a hair ahead of competing Indian and Bangladeshi offerings thanks to domestic fundamentals that have displayed comparatively more positivity in recent times whereby not only have steel plate prices remained steadfast at USD 615/Ton for a while now – far above industry averages for 2025 and much better placed to offer even higher levels now that the currency has also reversed its course and firmed consistently over recent weeks including this one, where it jumped nearly 20 basis points and close the week out at PKR 282.42 (having nearly skirted the edges of PKR 285 a month or so ago).

Pricing ahead.

Moreover, with local recyclers having failed to initiate meaningful steps towards improving their yards and local authorities now agreeing to grant provisional DASR certificates to those yards who have demonstrated recent progress and upgrades, has provided further impetus for recyclers to position themselves slightly above their neighboring competition. Consequently, geographically positioned tonnage and even some units from the Far East have been coming in, including a recent flurry of both wet and dry units have been winding up in gleeful Pakistani hands of late and even this week, where a couple of fresh, decent LDT dry cargo arrivals were reported, one of whom has already been delivered to meet her final end.

Momentum makers.

How long can or will this momentum be maintained is anyone's guess, and certainly relevant in current times given that tariffs to the tune of 19% - reportedly negotiated down from 29% and being claimed by chief advisor to the finance minister of Pakistan, as the best rate to be negotiated in the Indian sub-continent and Eastern markets. While this is certainly better than the likely 30% tariffs that the Indian market, and already imposed 20% tariffs hitting the Bangladeshi market may certainly give Gadani recyclers an edge across August, and perhaps beyond, as long as they maintain their levels and don't retreat to re-position themselves slightly below their neighboring competition, as they have historically done so and especially now that there is clearly an increase in vessel introductions.

Potential delays?

Notwithstanding, bearing in mind that local yards in Gadani still have some ways to go before a decent number of local yards have completed their HKC upgrades and no longer have to operate basis provisional DASR certificates, the industry could continue to exploit Pakistan's firmer offerings in the meantime. Although, they too will likely have to go through their own teething phase of inward clearance delays and procedural hurdles when the time comes.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

WHAT'S THERE TO SAY?

Bangladesh moment.

Nothing to report from Turkey this week - nada, zip, zilch, save for the trusty Lira that has lost all track of physics and continues to plummet week after week, including this one where it fell nearly 35 basis and ended the week at TRY 40.62 against the U.S. Dollar. Other than that, vessel offerings remain steady, there have been no major changes to import and / or local steel plate prices reported, no market vessels offered basis an Aliaga re-delivery, nor any reports of local arrivals.

Seems like a Bangladesh moment.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 31 of 2025, GMS Market Rankings / vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Pakistan	**Steady**	425 / LDT	445 / LDT	455 / LDT
2	India	**Steady**	415 / LDT	435 / LDT	445 / LDT
3	Bangladesh	**Weak**	405 / LDT	425 / LDT	435 / LDT
4	Turkey	**Weak**	250 / LDT	260 / LDT	270 / LDT

WEIRD ONES!!

- *The word 'set' holds the record for having the most definitions of any single word. According to Guinness World Records, there are 430 different definitions for the word 'set' in the 1989 Second Edition of the Oxford English Dictionary. In fact, the entry is 60k words.*
- *The release of all of the original Star Wars trilogy is closer in time to WWII than the present day. The first film in the original Star Wars trilogy came out in 1977. WWII ended in 1945, which means they are 32 years between them. If you want to take this to extremes, though, the final film in the trilogy — Return of the Jedi — came out in 1983, which is 38 years after WWII ended. It's 2024 at the time of my writing this article, which means there are 47 years between the first film of the trilogy and now and 41 years between Return of the Jedi and today. So, yeah, the math is mathing!*
- *Water towers are for water pressure, not just a town putting its name on a tank and saying, 'Hey, look how much dang water WE have.' They also store water to compensate for peak demand hours. This prevents the pumps from switching on and off frequently.*
- *Your pee is filtered out of your BLOOD by your kidneys. There's no direct route for that glass of water from swallow to kidneys to pee (like food/feces has its own set of pipes, from in to out). Water goes into your blood circulation (absorbed through the gut) and at some point, it gets lifted by your kidneys (along with other waste products) via your blood.*
- *Trees get the vast majority of their mass from the air. All that wood? That was once carbon dioxide and sunlight.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
August 09 – Raksha Bandhan August 15 – Independence Day August 16 - Janmashtami	August 08 – August 16 August 20 – August 27

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
August 05 – July Mass Uprising Day August 15 – National Mourning Day August 16 - Janmashtami	August 09 – August 12 August 22 – August 25

BANK HOLIDAYS		
CHINA	**PAKISTAN**	**TURKEY**
No holidays until September	August 14 – Independence Day	August 30 – Victory Day

Prices indicated above are as reported in the market and are not necessarily accurate. This information is provided without prejudice and is given in good faith and without any guarantees whatsoever. While every care has been taken in the preparation of this report, no liability can be accepted for any loss incurred in any way whatsoever by any person relying on the information contained herein. Opinions expressed herein may be deemed subjective and arbitrary. This WEEKLY is intended only for the person or entity to which it is addressed and may contain confidential and/or privileged material. Any review, retransmission, dissemination, or other use of this information by persons or entities other than the intended recipient is prohibited.

ALANG - Port Position as of August 01, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Aewo	5,245	Chemical Tanker	Arrived July 30
2	Ange	1,974	Oil Tanker	Arrived July 29
3	**Conica Atlas**	**20,001**	**Oil Tanker**	**Arrived June 13**
4	*Green Egersund*	*2,975*	*Reefer*	*Delivered July 26*
5	*Lusay*	*2,979*	*Reefer*	*Delivered July 31*
6	**Nirvana**	**9,623**	**Oil Tanker**	**Arrived May 07**
Total Tonnage		**42,797**		

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of August 01, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Leonid	13,605.90	Oil Tanker	Arrived July 28
		13,606		

GADANI - Port Position as of July 31, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Best 8	2,571	General Cargo	Arrived July 30
2	*Elian*	*8,118*	*Bulk Carrier*	*Delivered July 31*
Total Tonnage		**10,689**		

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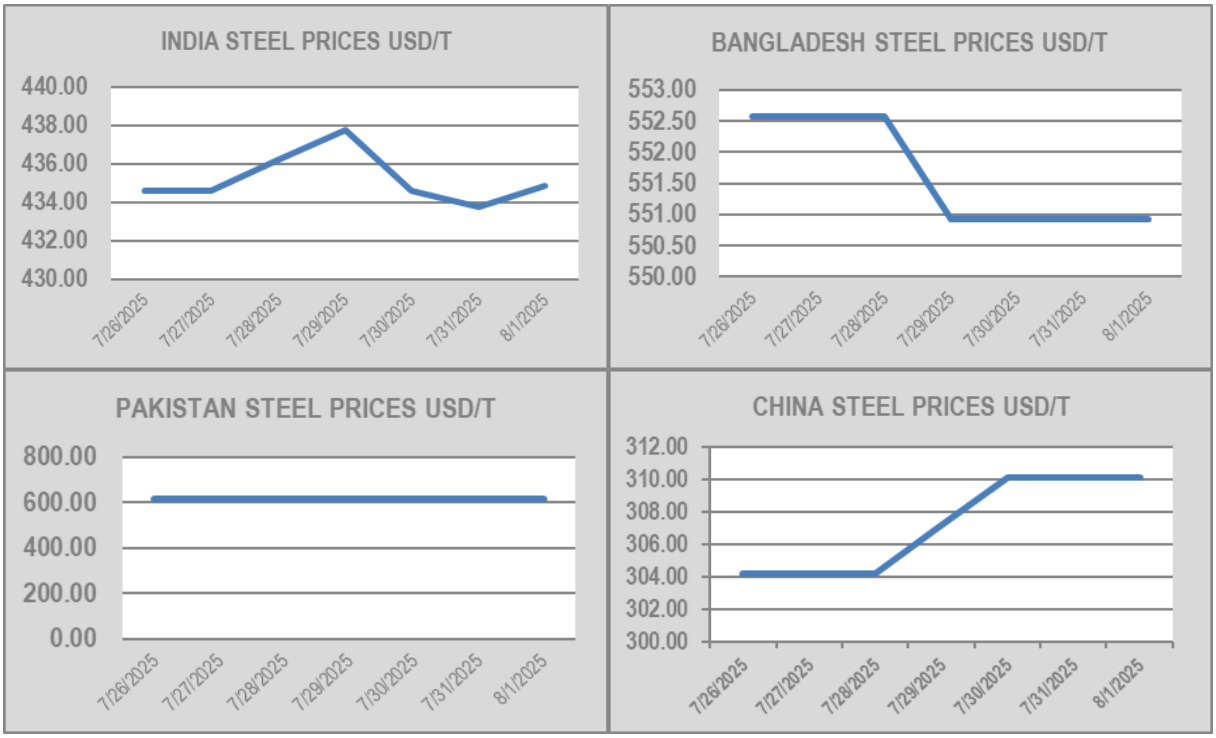
DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
7/26/2025	434.58	37,600.00	615.44	175,000.00	552.58	67,000.00	304.20
7/27/2025	434.58	37,600.00	615.44	175,000.00	552.58	67,000.00	304.20
7/28/2025	436.19	37,800.00	615.44	175,000.00	552.58	67,000.00	304.20
7/29/2025	437.74	38,000.00	615.44	175,000.00	550.93	66,800.00	307.16
7/30/2025	434.63	38,000.00	615.44	175,000.00	550.93	66,800.00	310.16
7/31/2025	433.79	38,000.00	615.44	175,000.00	550.93	66,800.00	310.16
8/1/2025	434.88	38,000.00	615.44	175,000.00	550.93	66,800.00	310.16



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